

Title: Guide: Slowpush, Crashing, Opponent slowpush, Opponent crash then start again. First intermediate concept you need to know to master wave management

Score:

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Hey all, first of all I'm going to assume you already know the basics, what's a freeze, what's a cheater recall, a slow push, minions doing extra damage for you, etc. But you might not be sure when these concepts apply, how they relate to each other, or when/if you should do any of those. So I'm going to start with the first advanced concept you need to know, which incorporates all of those, so make sure you study the basics first. Now I'm a top laner, but all of this applies to every lane (with small adjustments).

So the wave is usually going to be slowpushing. Yeah it can be neutral too but that's short lived. What happens when you put two good players on an even matchup, is that a cycle will naturally develop. Its slowpush, crashing, opponent slowpush, opponent crash then start again. If both players are good and there is no particular power spike, mistake, or external help this cycle is locked for the entirety of the lanephase. None of the laners have an incentive to break it since you would have to beat your opponent inside his slow push, which is not happening if the matchup is even. So both laners end up trading slow pushing cycles until something happens, a gank, a tp play, a mistake, etc.

During the slowpush you are usually stronger because you have more minions, but you are also forced to defend the wave, otherwise your opponent freezes on you. It is your objective to make sure the wave crashes. During your opponent's slowpush, you are weaker but you also can just wait the wave as needed, although be careful you don't get dove during his crash. You shouldn't ever put yourself in a risky situation now because you are not losing farm at this point, you can farm most of the wave after the crash. Lane bullies that get outscaled do have some pressure to make things

happen however, usually by warding and trying to freeze.

All of the plays that happen between two good players usually revolve around breaking or maintaining this cycle. That diamond camille probably won't just let renek jump on her and murder her because she understands her limits and reneks engage range. But renek can threaten to freeze on her, forcing her to fight for the crash or forfeit the lane. That diamond camille probably won't die to a gank that's happening while she waits for the slowpush, she will never waste e because she has nothing to lose by waiting safely for reneks crash. But she can get killed if renek threatens a freeze and camille is forced to e to win that fight.

Usually your win condition is either breaking the cycle by freezing or diving as the bully, or maintaining the cycle as the scaler(or the poor dude that got countered).

There's plenty of common plays towards those two objectives, and I've named a few already, they are not in the scope of this guide, it's just important to understand how they relate towards the goals of either maintaining or breaking the cycle. There's also some exceptions like champs whose win con is pushing and roaming, or sieging and poking for plates, but that's rarer in top.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 72]

Can someone explain what a cheater recall is?

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[Comment 3 | Score: 5]

What if i slow push but my jungler comes through mid hard pushing for no reason and stealing cs

[Comment 4 | Score: 3]

its cheetah recall, and its called that cuz its fast like a cheetah

[Comment 5 | Score: 2]

So we assume both parties know their place well, and are playing perfectly.

I'm a supp main with secondary top lane and I cannot solve one equation for the life of it.

As you have said the lane bully can threaten to freeze.

Now what happens when he does that and we both know at top permafreezing is a thing.

So question: how do you break the freeze of a ghost/flash darius with a melee champion.

Regardless of elo (mine is plat/diamond) we assume that you're on your own and nobody is going to interfere from either side.

Dairus is freezing with 3 caster minions, and for the funsies let's assume he has stridebreaker because I like the challenge.

I'm open to solutions.